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Which AI Should Do This?

Three real pages, straight off the shipping files,
plus everything the full download includes.



THE RULE

Who reads it, and can they catch it?

Not "which model is best." **Best at what, for whom, checked by whom.** Ask these two about any job before you pick anything.

1 • Who sees this output?

You, before anybody else? A student, directly? A parent? An administrator? **The further it travels without you in the middle, the more care it needs.**

2 • If it were wrong, would that get caught?

This is the one people skip, and it is the one that decides. A wrong score you glance at and change costs four seconds. **A wrong explanation a student reads alone and believes costs a week**, and you may never find out it happened.

So: **checked work can use the cheap fast model. Unchecked work cannot.**

And the third question, only when the first two fail

How much text is involved? **A whole novel, ten years of notes, thirty essays at once** — some models hold far more at once than others, and you move the axis from careful-versus-fast. If the job is large, check that before anything else, because a model that cannot hold the material will not do the job at any price.

Write the reason down, in one sentence, wherever you decided it.

Not for anybody else — for you in March, when somebody asks why the marking uses one thing and the study guides use another. **"A student reads this and nobody checks it, so it uses the careful one"** is a complete and defensible answer, and you will not reconstruct it from memory.

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Nine classroom jobs, and which side they fall on

The job	Who checks it	Which model
An explanation a student reads on their own	Nobody	The careful one
Feedback sent straight to a student	Nobody	The careful one
A message that goes home to a parent	You, but it leaves the building	The careful one
Anything a colleague will present from	Them, without your context	The careful one
A first-draft score you review	You, every time	The fast cheap one
Sorting or tagging a pile of work	You, at a glance	The fast cheap one
Rewriting your own draft	You, obviously	The fast cheap one
Brainstorming, twenty ideas to pick three	You, by picking	The fast cheap one
Summarizing a long document you will read anyway	You	The fast cheap one

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Notice what the pattern is not

It is not "important jobs get the good model." Scoring feels more important than brainstorming, and it is on the cheap side — **because you look at every score**. Importance is not the axis. **Being caught is the axis.**

The one that catches people out

Anything a student reads without you in between is the strictest case in the list, and it is the one most often done on autopilot with whatever was cheapest. A study guide, a hint, a worked example, a revision summary — if they read it alone and believe it, it needs the careful model and it needs you to have read it once.

How to tell which is which, without the names

Open the model list in whatever tool you use. **You are looking for three things**, and every provider publishes all three.

1 Price, which is the reliable signal

On the pricing page the models are listed with a rate each. **The most expensive is the careful one and the cheapest is the fast one**, and providers do not get that backwards. If you read nothing else, read the price order.

2 How much it can hold at once

Published as a context window or a token limit. **This is the axis that decides whether the job is possible at all**, separately from careful-versus-fast. A whole class set of essays is a lot of text.

3 Whether it thinks before it answers

Most tools now offer a slower mode that reasons first. **Worth it for anything with steps — grading against a rubric, working a problem —** and wasted on rewriting a sentence.

The chatbot version of the same decision

If you use a chat tool rather than something built, the dropdown at the top is the right choice. **The rule is unchanged:** switching to the careful model costs you a few coins' waiting, and it is worth it for anything a student will read and nobody will check. For your own newsletter, the fast one is fine and you will notice the difference in speed more than you will notice the difference in quality.

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One check that costs a minute and settles most arguments.

Run the *same* job through two models and read both answers side by side. **If you cannot tell them apart, use the cheap one** — that is a measurement, not a preference, and it is the only way to know for your subject and your students rather than in general.



WHAT IS INSIDE

Which AI Should Do This?

- ✓ **The one rule** that settles it every time
- ✓ The two questions to ask about any job
- ✓ **Nine classroom jobs**, already sorted
- ✓ How to read the model menu without the names
- ✓ **A fill-in page** for three of your own jobs

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